



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*sarvabhūteṣu cātmānaṃ sarvabhūtāni cātmani |
munerjānata āścaryaṃ mamatvamanuvartate | 3 | 5 |*

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 3 (Chapter 3), Verse 5

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This verse speaks of the realized soul who sees the Self, the Atman, in all beings, and simultaneously sees all beings residing within the Self. Imagine perceiving the universe as a vast ocean and recognizing that every wave, every drop, is fundamentally water, just as you are. This is the wisdom of the knower, a state of interconnectedness and unity.

Yet, the verse doesn't paint a picture of perfect immunity. It acknowledges the surprising persistence of egoic attachments. Even when your intellect understands the illusion of separation, the deeply ingrained habits of the mind – the "mine" and "yours," the desires and aversions – can linger. This is not a failure, but a testament to the strength of conditioning. It's like a phantom limb pain, a sensation that persists even after the limb is gone.

In modern life, this verse reminds us that spiritual progress isn't about attaining an unattainable perfection, but about cultivating awareness. You may intellectually grasp the concept of oneness, yet still find yourself caught in jealousy, anger, or possessiveness. The key is to observe these emotions without judgment, recognizing them as echoes of the past, not defining truths. Don't beat yourself up for feeling them; instead, use them as opportunities for deeper self-inquiry. Ask yourself, "What am I truly attached to? What fear is driving this possessiveness?" By gently unraveling these knots of attachment, you gradually loosen their grip and move closer to the freedom and peace that the Atman offers. The journey is not about eradicating the ego, but about understanding its limitations and transcending its influence. It is about recognizing that even amidst the chaos and attachments of life, the truth of your being, the radiant Self, remains untouched and unwavering.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If possessiveness arises even after profound understanding, what compassionate steps can you take today to gently loosen its hold on your heart and mind?